The Ultimate AI Cheat Sheet

Practical AI for small and medium businesses, in plain English.

SAVE THIS · PART 1 OF 4

1 Which tool for which job

Microsoft 365 Copilot
Your team lives in Microsoft

Gemini
You run on Google

ChatGPT
You want one all-rounder

Claude OUR PICK
Best writing, analysis and long documents

Start with the one your team already pays for.

2 The prompt formula

Role + Task + Context + Format

✗ "Write a follow-up email."

✓ "As our sales manager, write a follow-up to a client gone quiet after a quote. They run a family bakery. Under 120 words, one clear next step."

Paste in an example of good work and it will follow it.

3 Hand these to AI first

Sales
Proposals, follow-ups, call prep, LinkedIn posts

Customers
Reply drafts, FAQs, complaints, review replies

Operations
Process guides from a voice note, checklists

Finance
Explain the numbers, chase late payers

Admin
Meeting notes, actions, agendas, job adverts

4 Twelve useful prompt starters

01 You are our [role]. Write [task].
02 Turn these notes into a summary.
03 Rewrite this to be clearer and shorter.
04 Give three options, then pick one.
05 What should I ask before deciding?
06 Find the weak points in this proposal.
07 Put this in a table with [columns].
08 Explain this report to a non-expert.
09 Draft a reply that says no politely.
10 Turn this into a step-by-step checklist.
11 Summarise this thread and list actions.
12 Write three subject lines for this.

5 Teach AI your business

- Projects in Claude and ChatGPT
- Gems in Gemini
- Add price list, tone guide, FAQs
- Connect email, calendar, files

6 Never paste in

- ✗ Customer personal data
- ✗ Passwords or bank details
- ✗ Anything under NDA
- ✗ Contracts and HR files
- ✗ Unpublished financial results

7 Check before it leaves

- ✓ Facts, figures and dates
- ✓ Names and spellings
- ✓ Tone for this customer
- ✓ Anything legal or financial
- ✓ Promises you can't keep

8 Habits of good users

- ✓ Give it an example
- ✓ Tell it who will read it
- ✓ Ask it to critique itself
- ✓ Reply to improve, don't restart
- ✓ Save prompts that work

9 Start this week

Pick one weekly job
Like the Monday report

Write the prompt
Role, task, context, format

Save as a template
In a shared Project

Measure time back
Minutes before and after

10 Power moves

Talk, don't type
Voice notes into emails and plans

Show it a picture
Screenshots, receipts, whiteboards

Let it interview you
"Ask me five questions first"

Ask for a table
Then turn it into an email or slide

Key terms

Prompt
The instruction you give the AI

LLM
The engine behind tools like these

Hallucination
A confident answer that is wrong

Context window
How much it can read at once

Connector
A link to your email, files or apps

Agent
AI that does tasks, not just answers

Share with someone who needs this

Comment "AI" for the full guide

AIforCompanies